

If you've already made the college decision, are in a highly paid career you're satisfied with, have no college debt, and don't have kids to help navigate these decisions you can probably skip or skim this chapter. You've already won this part of the game.

If you've finished college and are in a rewarding career, but school loans are handicapping your ability to save toward a FI lifestyle, you'll need to determine the optimal strategy to handle your loans so you can move forward.

If you've gone to college and found you're not satisfied with your career choice, you may need to gain further training to switch careers. Others among you may have found FI early in life before making the college decision. Others still may be working toward FI while simultaneously planning for your children's education.

If you fit into these categories, you will have a different decision tree. You should question the assumption that college is right for everyone. If you want to be a doctor or medical professional, lawyer, engineer, or accountant, that answer is clearly yes. For others, like those looking to be entrepreneurs, computer coders, trade workers, or pursuing a career in the arts, the answer is far less clear.

If you decide college is the right choice, you will need to determine how to get the most value while spending the least